AI AGENTS · ACCOUNTABILITY

Your AI agent isn’t like your co-worker.

It doesn’t understand accountability like an adult does.

Here’s how to keep it on track →

STEPS 1 AND 2

First define good. Then let machines check.

1 Write the “acceptance criteria” first

Pass or fail. Written before the run.

2a Facts: a script or a list

It matches or it doesn’t.

2b Inferences: a reasoning model

It points at what to doubt. Flags, not verdicts.

STEPS 3 AND 4

Then check in only on what's flagged.

3 Human check

Check in on the flags, plus the judgment calls no check can settle.

4 Feed back

Fix the same thing twice and it becomes a criterion. Ones the model has outgrown come off, like training wheels.

Four steps to keep an AI agent on track

1 Define

Write pass/fail “acceptance criteria” before the run.

criteria

2 · MACHINE CHECK

2a Deterministic

Factual claims. Number to its query, acronym to a list, quote to the transcript.

2b Reasoning model

Inference claims. Contradictions and findings on thin evidence.

flags only

3 Human check

Check in only on the flags, plus the judgment calls no check can settle.

corrections

4 Feed back

Repeats become new criteria. Retire the ones the model outgrows.

Full essay: link in the comments

Subir’s PM Teardown